

PICKLING



Kids (under 10)

Q

What color do cucumbers turn when they are cooked just right for pickles?

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ANSWER

They change from bright to dull green

FUN FACT

Cucumbers change color when heated to look different!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Which of these helps pickles stay safe and not spoil?

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ANSWER

Vinegar that tastes sour

FUN FACT

The sourness in vinegar stops bad germs from growing.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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When making sauerkraut, what keeps the cabbage under the salty water?

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ANSWER

A weight like a plate or jars

FUN FACT

The weight helps the cabbage stay under the water so it can turn into tasty sauerkraut!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What happens if you use less vinegar than the recipe says in pickles?

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ANSWER

The pickles might get spoiled and unsafe

FUN FACT

You must use enough vinegar to keep pickles safe and tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What feeling do you get when you taste a crunchy, fresh pickle?

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ANSWER

It feels crisp and sounds crunchy

FUN FACT

Pickles can be fun to hear crunch when you bite them!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Which jar lid makes a little pop sound when a pickle jar is safely sealed?

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ANSWER

A metal lid that pops down

FUN FACT

The popping sound means your pickles are sealed tight and safe.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What do pickling salt and table salt have in common?

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ANSWER

Both are salty but pickling salt has no minerals that cloud pickles

FUN FACT

Pickling salt keeps your pickles clear and tasty without cloudiness!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Which vegetable can you pickle to make sour, yummy sauerkraut?

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ANSWER

Cabbage

FUN FACT

Sauerkraut is made by letting cabbage get sour and tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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If you want a crunchy pickle, what part of the cucumber do you cut off first?

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ANSWER

The very blossom end is cut off

FUN FACT

Cutting off the blossom end helps make pickles nice and crunchy!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What smell do you expect when you open a jar of pickles?

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ANSWER

A fresh, sour vinegar smell

FUN FACT

Pickles smell sour and fresh because of the vinegar!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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What keeps the good microbes safe while vegetables ferment into pickles?

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ANSWER

Salt water called brine

FUN FACT

The salty brine helps good microbes grow and make pickles safe.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Which container is best for making fermented pickles at home?

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ANSWER

Food-safe crocks or glass jars

FUN FACT

Only use containers made for food to keep pickles safe!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What color are sweet gherkin pickles usually?

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ANSWER

They are green and small

FUN FACT

Sweet gherkin pickles are tiny green cucumbers.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What do you add with vinegar to make flavor in pickled mushrooms?

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ANSWER

Spices like oregano and basil

FUN FACT

Yummy herbs and spices make pickled mushrooms tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why do some pickles have a fizz or bubbles when they're fermenting?

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ANSWER

Because good bacteria are making tiny bubbles

FUN FACT

Bubbles mean the pickle bacteria are hard at work!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Where should you store jars of pickles after canning to keep them good?

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ANSWER

In a cool, dark place

FUN FACT

Pickles like cool dark places to stay yummy.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Can you use a metal spoon made of copper or brass to stir pickles safely?

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ANSWER

No, these metals can ruin the pickles

FUN FACT

Some metals and pickles don't mix well and can spoil the pickles!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

If you want a less salty pickle, what should you do?

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ANSWER

Use a tested recipe for reduced-sodium pickles

FUN FACT

Careful recipes help make pickles less salty but still safe.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why do you rinse cucumbers before pickling sometimes?

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ANSWER

To remove extra salt from soaking

FUN FACT

Rinse cucumbers to wash off salt so they taste just right!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What happens if you don't keep cabbage under the salty water when making sauerkraut?

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Kids (under 10)

ANSWER

Mold and yucky stuff can grow on top

FUN FACT

Keeping cabbage underwater keeps sauerkraut safe and yummy!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs